



THE minstrel show was definitely an American form of entertainment. Minstrel companies were made up of a cast of men who blacked their faces, dressed in gaudy costumes, sang negro songs, played banjos, danced taps, clogs, etc. Dan Emmett, the composer of *Dixie* was a member of the *Virginia Minstrels*. Stephen Foster wrote *Old Folks at Home* and other of his famous songs for *Christy's Minstrels*. About 1870, when minstrelsy was exceedingly popular, a coloured composer, James A. Bland, wrote this beautiful plantation melody which has been sung by the greatest artists in concert and over the radio.

Carry Me Back to Old Virginny

James A. Bland

Introduction Moderato



Andantino



